



**INSTITUTE OF RURAL DEVELOPMENT PLANNING
(IRDP)**

**STUDENTS' GUIDELINES FOR WRITING
DISSERTATIONS**

JANUARY 2013

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Main Campus

P. O. BOX 138

DODOMA

Tanzania

Tel: +255 26 2302147 - Direct
+255 26 2303190 - General

Fax: +255 26 2301341

Email: irdp@irdp.ac.tz,
rector@irdp.ac.tz

Website: www.irdp.ac.tz

Lake Zone Centre

P. O. BOX 11957

MWANZA

Tanzania

Tel: +255 22 28256095

Fax: +255 282560994

Email: irdp@irdp.ac.tz,
rector@irdp.ac.tz

Website: www.irdp.ac.tz

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PREFACE

The Institute of Rural Development Planning examination regulations require every student to carry out a research work and prepare a dissertation as requirement for the award of bachelor degree or postgraduate diploma. The dissertation submitted for consideration for any award is required to meet the set standards with respect to format and literary presentation. Failure of students to observe some of these regulations will lead to either discontinuation from studies or delay in completing studies. Therefore, this document has been prepared to assist both undergraduate and post graduate students in preparing their dissertation. It is also hoped that, this guide will be helpful to supervisors and examiners in ensuring uniformity of writing dissertations.

It should be noted here that preparation of good quality dissertation will greatly minimize frustrations to students, headaches for supervisors, examiners and readers alike. Furthermore, a dissertation which is written in a format that best fits the need of its readers enables them to follow it easily and if possible put into practice the recommendations made.

May I take this opportunity to kindly request all students and supervisors to effectively use this document to make the work easier.

Deputy Rector – Academics

January 2013

PART I: PREPARING A RESEARCH PROPOSAL THE COVER PAGE

- 1. INSTITUTE OF RURAL DEVELOPMENT PLANNING**
- 2. DEPARTMENT:** eg Population Studies
- 3. PROGRAMME PURSUED:** eg Bachelors Degree in Population and Development Planning
- 4. TITLE OF THE PROPOSED RESEARCH:** eg Dairying Contribution to the Small-holder Farmers' Livelihoods: A case of Mtwango ward in Njombe district
- 5. RESEARCHER'S/STUDENT'S NAME*** eg John C. Futui
- 6. SUPERVISOR'S NAME*** eg R. M. Mgabo
- 7. DATE OF PROPOSAL SUBMISSION:** eg September, 2012

PROPOSAL FRAMEWORK

1.0 INTRODUCTION

- 1.1 Background Information
- 1.2 Statement of the Problem
- 1.3 Significance of the study
- 1.4 Research Objectives
 - 1.4.1 General Objective
 - 1.4.2 Specific Objectives
- 1.5 Research Questions/Hypotheses
- 1.6 Scope of the Study

2.0 LITERATURE REVIEW

- 2.1 Theoretical review
- 2.2 Empirical review
- 2.3 Information gap
- 2.4 Conceptual Framework

3.0 RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

- 3.1 Study area
- 3.2 Research Design
- 3.3 Data types and sources
- 3.4 Data collection methods and tools
- 3.5 Sampling
 - 3.5.1 Sampling frame
 - 3.5.2 Sampling unit
 - 3.5.3 Sample size.
 - 3.5.4 Sampling procedures
- 3.6 Detailed Field Work
- 3.7 Data Processing, Analysis and Presentation
(Each of the items above briefly and clearly explained)

4.0 RESEARCH SCHEDULE OF ACTIVITIES

5.0 RESEARCH BUDGET AND SOURCE OF FUNDS

- 5.1 Budget size and breakdown
- 5.2 Financier/source of funds

6.0 REFERENCES

7.0 APPENDICES

1.0 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background Information

Problem area (issue) to be defined and briefly discussed. In defining the problem area give brief location profile. In discussing the problem give (i) tentative genesis/source/cause of the problem and (ii) extent/coverage/status of the problem at different levels e.g. at international, regional, national and at local levels.

1.2 Statement of the Problem

State the nature of the difficulty, hence the problem as it is perceived. Why considering the problem to be important i.e. how big is the problem. Presence of the problem must be supported by at least three current peer reviewed references. Therefore, statement of the problem is the section that identifies issues of concern, their extent and the associated impacts if they are not addressed. The argument should be supported by current empirical evidence. Magnitude, severity and discrepancy should be clearly revealed.

1.3 Significance of the Study

How the study findings will contribute to the knowledge of the phenomenon or solve the problem. State why conducting the study particularly the benefits to be derived from the study findings and who will benefit. The focus should be to the usefulness of the findings of the study.

NB: Assess justification using four parameters: Non-repetition/duplication of information, Usefulness of findings, Timeliness of problem, Feasibility of research completion.

1.4 Research Objectives

These are general and specific objectives.

1.4.1 General objective

- This should reflect the general intention of the research to address the study problem.

1.4.2 Specific objectives

These should focus specific issues which are components of the general research intention or general objective. Normally they originate from the statement of the problem identified as issues of concern. About 3 specific objectives are preferable for a single research and to be listed in logical order. Both general and specific objectives are diverse in the sense that they have intention of:

- Exploration of a problem
- Description and expansion of factors/conditions
- Identification of interrelationship between factors in order in order to explain specific phenomena
- Assess the opinions and/or attitudes
- Evaluation of the effects of development interventions etc.

Research objectives are normally stated with action word “to” or doing verb ending with Exploring, Assessing, Evaluating etc. By attaining the specific objectives, the study goal is met and contribution to solving the problem is made. It is however, important to note that because problems that inspire scholarly research are usually complex in nature, the contribution of solutions to the problem is usually small.

1.5 Research Questions/Hypotheses

A Research Question is a statement that identifies the phenomenon to be studied. For example, “What resources are helpful to new and minority drug abuse researchers?” The research questions should include the operationalized variables. In general terms Research question is all about investigating about the phenomenon of study.

A well-thought-out and focused research question leads directly into your hypotheses. Hypotheses are more specific predictions about the nature and direction of the relationship between two variables. For example, “Those researchers who utilize an online grant writing tutorial will have higher priority scores on their next grant application than those who do not.” In general terms use of hypotheses is all about confirmation about the phenomenon.

1.6 Scope of the Study

State the boundary of the study in terms of (i) content of the study (narrate what is stated in specific objectives) and (ii) geographical coverage.

2.0 LITERATURE REVIEW

This is important for a clear definition of the problem. It indicates the information already available and what is missing hence helps to identify information gap. It is important to end with conclusion of the clear gap existing and how to deal with it. This should indicate analysis of concepts and theories supported with citation of various literature/references. Two major sections of the literature review should be made; i).Theoretical review ii).Empirical review followed by information gap and conceptual/ theoretical framework

2.1 Conceptual Framework/Theoretical frame work

Conceptual framework is a simplified systematic conceptual structure of interrelated elements in some schematic form, which describes the relationships between and among concepts and variables.

- It distinguishes clearly different types of variables to be studied and specifies the nature of relationship between them.
- This is one of the first steps in developing research plan.
- The researcher is expected to outline some of the relevant theoretical background of the intended field of

study/enquiry e.g. rural sociology, rural economy, economics, environmental sociology, population studies, development finance investment planning, Governance project planning and management etc.

- The researcher must be conversant with the relevant theories in the field of study.
- Some specific questions may be of help in making appropriate conceptual framework of a study, such as:

What theory/theories are related to your research? Do they provide framework for your study? What variables can be studied in the framework? Conceptual framework may easily originate from problem tree.

3.0 RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The methodology outlines the research design, methods, procedures and tools that the candidate will use to produce the study results which permits the candidate to draw conclusions from the study.

3.1 Selection of the Study Area

State the rationale for choosing the study area. Briefly describe some physical and socio-economic characteristics of the area related to the problems which may also be part of the background information.

3.2 Research Design

A research design refers to the main approach used to test cause-and-effect relationships between variables or address key research questions. The classic experimental design specifies an experimental group and a control group. The independent variable is administered to the experimental group and not to the control group, and both groups are measured on the same dependent variable. Subsequent experimental designs have used more groups and more measurements over longer periods.

True experiments must have control, randomization, and manipulation.

Several research designs for social studies exist, those designs which suit some studies are such as:

- **Experimental studies** whereby one sets some laboratory or field experiments to test some hypotheses
- **Case study design** an investigation strategy involving extensive exploration of a single unit of study, which may be a person, family, group, community, or institution, or a very small number of subjects who are examined intensively over a long period of time. The number of variables is usually very large.
- **Cross-sectional design** a research strategy in which one or more group(s) of subjects are studied at one given point in time.
- **Longitudinal design** a research strategy in which one or more group(s) of subjects in various stages of development are examined simultaneously with the intent of inferring trends over time.
- **Survey designs** a design in which data are collected with questionnaires or through personal interviews with members of an identified population.

3.3 Data Types and Sources

State the base of data. This may be either secondary (documentary/second hand data) or primary (survey/first hand data). The secondary data sources may be reports, books, journals either published or unpublished ones but, readily available. Primary data are the ones directly collected from the field by the researcher. The best thing with primary unlike secondary sources is that the former are directly related to the study, whereas the latter may need some modifications.

3.4 Data Collection Methods and Tools

Depending on the nature of the study valid and reliable methods and tools for collection of different types of data should be stated at this section. Clearly indicate which methods to be used in the collection of data stated in section 3.3. The methods can either be (i) Observation (experimentation, participatory or non-participatory) (ii) Interview (iii) Focus group discussion (iv) Mail survey (v) Telephone survey etc or tools being questionnaire and check list. For secondary data state which documents will be used e.g. reports, records, published or unpublished documents etc and the office with the documents. Before deciding on the secondary data ascertain their reliability and suitability for the study as well as their accuracy. A combination of sources of data or data collection methods may be adopted for a good research that will ensure the validity and reliability of the data collected.

3.5 Sampling of Respondents

This highlights the following items.

3.5.1 Sampling frame

This is a list of the entire population from which the sample is to be drawn.

3.5.2 Sampling unit

This is a single entity/item/element composing the sampling frame or study population. In social science research they may be: individual person, household, village, ward, district, school, organization, etc.

3.5.3 Sample size

This is a number of items/elements to be selected from the population (sampling frame) to constitute a sample. Sample size should be optimal with regards to: efficiency of doing the research, representation of the study population, reliability of data to be collected and flexibility in executing the research.

The optimal sample size depends on the: (i) Nature of the study phenomenon and population-high variability demands larger sample size (ii) Population size-larger population size need relatively larger representative sample. (iii) Research cost-larger sample means more cost and vice versa. (iv) Time availability-larger samples demands much time for data collection etc.

3.5.4 Sampling procedure

This involves decision on the techniques to be used in selecting the items of the sample. One or both of the main techniques may be adopted, which are:

- (a) Probability sampling techniques: these are: (i) simple random (ii) systematic (iii) stratified random (iv) cluster or (v) multistage sampling techniques may be adopted.
- (b) Non-probability sampling techniques: these are: (i) purposive (ii) judgemental and (iii) quota stratum (iv) snowball sampling (v) volunteers sampling (vi) accidental sampling

3.6 Detailed Field Work

Give a brief account on how you will operationalize the process of data collection. Indicate how you will organize data collection from respondents/experiments, starting from getting permit, training enumerators, and collecting data/doing experiments and abiding to research ethics.

3.7 Data Processing, Analysis and Presentation

Data processing and analysis indicates means/methods to be used e.g. the type of analysis to be carried out including the measurements of the variables or proxy variables described in the conceptual frame work and the means. Appropriate software for data processing and analysis should be used to meet the demand of specific objectives. In data presentation, state the forms in which results in various levels of analysis

will be presented e.g. using graphs, tables, equations or combination of these.

4.0 RESEARCH SCHEDULE OF ACTIVITIES

Indicate different research activities (from proposal development to research report submission) and for each activity date/period of commencement and completion.

5.0 RESEARCH BUDGET AND SOURCE OF FUNDS

Indicate cost for each section of the research work, sub-totals and grand totals. It worth also to indicate the financiers of the research or source of fund.

6.0 REFERENCES

- (a) List all references cited in full at the end of the text, and not as footnotes to the text pages, tables or figures,
- (b) The references should be arranged alphabetically by authors. All authors, surnames and initials should be included (i.e. never use *et al.*), followed by the year of publication in parentheses; a full stop, the title of the paper or report or book; etc. (as used in the original document and should not be abbreviated), the journal volume number; the issue number (only if the pagination starts afresh in each issue concerned). If the reference is to a book, the publisher, the town of publication, , the edition number (if not the first) should be added. Journal and book titles should be underlined or italicised.

7.0 APPENDICES

Tools for data collection should be presented in this section

Please attach all tools you are going to use in data collection and should be sited in your text e.g.

Appendix 1: Household Questionnaire

Appendix 2: Checklist for Focus Group Discussion

Appendix 3: Checklist for observation

PART II: PREPARING A RESEARCH REPORT (DISSERTATIONS)

I: PRELIMINARIES

1. Title page

The title of the study should be short at most 15 words and precise in such a way that the reader should understand it clearly upon looking at it. It should indicate the name of the author, degree/diploma requirement, the name of the awarding Institute and date of presentation. The cover page should appear as follows:

INSTITUTE OF RURAL DEVELOPMENT PLANNING, DODOMA



DEPARTMENT OF ENVIRONMENTAL PLANNING

**ASSESSMENT OF LAND USE CHANGES IN MINING AREAS
USING GIS AND REMOTE SENSING IN TANZANIA: A
CASE OF GEITA MINING AREA**

BY

FIRST NAME, SECOND NAME AND SUR NAME IN FULL

Eg. MARIAM MOHAMED KAYOWA

**A DISSERTATION SUBMITTED IN PARTIAL FULFILLMENT FOR THE
REQUIREMENTS OF THE AWARD OF BACHELOR DEGREE IN
ENVIRONMENTAL PLANNING AND MANAGEMENT OF THE
INSTITUTE OF RURAL DEVELOPMENT PLANNING, DODOMA,
TANZANIA**

AUGUST, 2012

2. ABSTRACT

This page should summarize the whole report in not more than **300 words**. It should contain a precise statement of where the study was carried out, the overall and specific objectives, method used for data collection and analysis and key findings. It should also contain a summary of conclusion and recommendations.

3. DECLARATION

In this page the candidate should declare that the whole study is her/his original work as follows:

I (Name) declare that this dissertation is my own original work and that it has not been presented to any other Institute for a similar or any other degree award

Candidate Name.....

Signature.....

Date.....

4. COPYRIGHT

The author should state for example, No part of this paper may be produced or transmitted in any form and by any means without permission of the writer or the Institute of Rural Development Planning.

5. RESEARCH SUPERVISOR'S CERTIFICATION

Student's supervisor(s) has to certify the research work done by the student as follows:-

I (Name) certify that I have read and hereby recommend for acceptance by the Institute of Rural Development Planning the dissertation entitled (title of dissertation) in fulfilment of the requirements for the degree/Postgraduate Diploma (name of the degree/PG diploma) of the Institute of Rural Development Planning.

Name of the supervisor(s).....
Signature.....
Date.....

6. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

In this page, researchers acknowledge the assistance and support received from individuals and organizations in carrying out the research. It is basically intended to express his/her gratitude. Thus it should not exceed one page

7. TABLE OF CONTENT

A table of contents gives an outline of the contents of the report. It should follow immediately after acknowledgement page. It shows in order of appearance a list of the chapter with page numbers.

8. LIST OF TABLES

This should follow after the table of content page, and should be presented in the following format:

Table Number	Title of the table	Page
.....		

9. LIST OF FIGURES

If there are many graphs, charts or any other including maps they should also be listed as follows:-

Number	Title	Page
.....		

10. LIST OF APPENDICES

This should follow after the list of figures

11. LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

The abbreviations used in the report should be arranged in the alphabetical order. In the text, an abbreviation is written in full for the first time followed by the abbreviation in brackets.

12. DEFINITIONS OF KEY TERMS/ VARIABLES

This page should follow after list of appendices.

Report should contain several chapters as follows:

CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

This is the first chapter in the research report. . Its main purpose is to provide the basis for the understanding of the problem under investigation. It contains the following sections:

1.1 Background of the Problem

This sub section gives some necessary background information so as to enable the reader to focus his/her thoughts for understanding of the research problem. A short historical perspective and findings from related studies are often used in this connection. The background information should not exceed **500 words**.

The main aim is to convince the reader that there is a problem that the study is aimed researching on. It should start from the broad to the specific information of the problem.

1.2 Statement of the Problem

In this section the research problem is clearly defined and stated basing on the information provided in the background of the study. This should include its facets and significance. It can be stated in the form of a declarative statement or in

question form, giving the discrepancy between what exists and what is supposed to exist.

1.3 Significance of the Study

In this section, the researcher should also spell out who or what organization he/she expects to benefit by the findings and recommendations of the study. Explanation on the usefulness of the study findings should be clearly presented at this section

1.4 Objectives of the Study

Here the overall objective or purpose of the study should be stated. This should be followed by stating specific objectives of the study. These are basically the specific indicators of the study carried out.

1.5 Research Questions/Hypotheses

1.5.1 Research questions

These are key questions that the researcher thinks by answering or finding solution to them, will contribute to a thorough understanding of the phenomenon or the problem under study. Questions should be able to generate information that meets the study objectives hence, should be linked with study objectives.

1.5.2 Hypotheses

Research hypothesis is a tentative answer to a research question. Hypotheses do sharpen researcher's focus on the key variables intended in the study and the expected relationships. In both quantitative and qualitative research, hypotheses are declarative statements that express relationships between two or more variables in such a way that relationships are testable empirically. Variables relationship and testability are the two essential criteria that must be satisfied. The testability criterion implies that the variables concerned can be empirically measured.

1.6 Scope of Study

A researcher should indicate here the boundary of his/her research in terms of content (breadth and depth of study), geographical area (spread to be covered, reference period, the type of respondents and institutions covered and the issues analyzed.

CHAPTER TWO

LITERATURE REVIEW

In this part the researcher should be able to show precisely how the problem of the study is related to the previous findings. It should demonstrate how the approaches of the study is different from others and indicate the gaps of knowledge left by previous studies which, in turn, have been fulfilled by the study. Therefore, this is an important part of the research as it provides the focus of the study and its direction towards filling in an identified gap. Depending on school of thought the literature be structured in a way that literature has much detail on empirical and theoretical reviews related to the topic of study. These can be conclude by elaborative conceptual framework.

"... a literature review uses as its database reports of primary or original scholarship, and does not report new primary scholarship itself. The primary reports used in the literature may be verbal, but in the vast majority of cases reports are written documents. The types of scholarship may be empirical, theoretical, critical/analytic, or methodological in nature. Second a literature review seeks to describe, summaries, evaluate, clarify and/or integrate the content of primary reports."

2.1 Theoretical Literature Review

2.2 Empirical Literature Review

2.3 Information Gap

2.4 Conceptual Framework

This is a simplified systematic conceptual structure of interrelated elements in some schematic form, which describes the relationships between and among concepts and variables. It distinguishes clearly different types of variables studied and specifies the nature of relationship between them. This can be in the form of a narrative statement, mathematical equation or an illustrated diagram.

CHAPTER THREE

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

In this chapter, describe what where and how the research work was done. The overall organization of this chapter should be as follows:

3.1 The Study Area

Explain the location of the study area, rationale for choosing the area and some physical and socio-economic characteristics relevant to the study area.

3.2 Research Design

Explain research design adopted in the study. This depends much on analysis intended to be used. Normally there are experimental and non experimental studies. The experimental has to follow standardised research design. For non experimental there are various research design such:

- **Case study design** an investigation strategy involving extensive exploration of a single unit of study, which may be a person, family, group, community, or institution, or a very small number of subjects who are examined intensively. The number of variables is usually very large.

- **Cross-sectional design**, a research strategy in which one or more group(s) of subjects are studied at one given point in time.
- **Longitudinal design** a research strategy in which one or more group(s) of subjects in various stages of development are examined simultaneously with the intent of inferring trends over time.
- **Survey designs** a design in which data are collected with questionnaires or through personal interviews with members of an identified population.

3.3 Data types and sources

Mention the types of data in your study. The sources from which both primary and secondary data were gathered are stated. In the case of primary data, the universe of the study and the unit of study are clearly defined. The limitations of the secondary source of data should be indicated.

3.4 Data Collection Methods and Tools

All method and tools instruments used in collecting different types of data from different sources should be well described here their contents and other devices for measuring variables and their validity and reliability are described.

3.5 Sampling

The size of the universe (sampling frame) from which the sample was drawn, sampling unit and the sampling methods adopted; the sample size (explain how you have arrived at the sample size) and the process of sampling are described. What were originally planned and what were actually achieved and the estimated sampling error are given. These details are crucial for determining the limitations of general usability of the findings.

3.6 Data Processing, Analysis and Presentation

Techniques used for data processing, and an account of methods used for data analysis and testing of hypothesis and justification are described.

3.7 Limitations of the Study

These are statements of what could not be controlled by the researcher. No research is free from limitation and weakness. These arise from methodological weaknesses, sampling imperfections, non-responses, data inadequacies or limited technical assistance. Therefore a careful statement of the limitations and weakness of the study should be made in order to enable the reader to judge the validity of the conclusions and general worth of the study in the proper perspective. In addition, candidate has to state how he/she addressed the limitations.

CHAPTER FOUR

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter attempts to extensively discuss the findings of the study and can be presented by discussing the respondents' characteristics, major findings and supplementary evidences; interpretation of findings and compare the results with the related studies or the literature review.

The chapter may be divided into several sub-chapters depending on the number of specific objectives of the study, each being devoted for presenting the results pertaining to an objective. The sub-chapters should be well-balanced mutually related and arranged in logical sequence.

CHAPTER FIVE

CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter intends to give pertinent conclusions which must be borne out of the analysis and discussion of the data used in the study and not on previously held convictions, or over generalization based on the limited available data. Recommendations for policy/action should flow from the findings and conclusions. Recommendations should be specific and practical; they should not be mere vague statements like “The government should ensure all civil servants are motivated”. They should rather indicated ‘what’, ‘how’ and other aspects of the action suggested i.e. they should be specific. Preferably each major finding for each specific objective should bear a specific conclusion and recommendation. Recommendations should include areas of further research.

II: TERMINAL ITEMS

REFERENCES

This is the first of the terminal items presented at the end of the research report. In preparing the report all used/reviewed published and unpublished documents both electronic and non electronic resources should be listed in alphabetical order. Bibliography/reference section gives a list of material relating to the topic/problem under study as a ready reference to readers. It defers from footnotes in that the footnotes cite the exact sources or pages where quoted or paraphrased materials are found.

APPENDICES

The appendix provides a place for materials that do not fit in the other parts of the research report due to either details, technical or specialized or not absolutely necessary for the text

e.g. questionnaires used, large Tables, maps, satellite imageries, checklists etc.

III: GENERAL PRINCIPLES OF WRITING GOOD QUALITY DISSERTATION

1. TYPESCRIPTS AND LAYOUT

The text should be in double spacing on one side of A-4 size good quality (80 g/m²) paper (210 x 297mm) with Times New Roman Font Style and 12 font size. Paginate the preliminaries (portions preceding the introduction) in lower case Roman numerals (i.e. i, ii, iii, etc.) beginning with the title page.

Number pages of the body of the dissertation in Arabic numbers (1, 2, 3, etc.) consecutively throughout. The page numbers should appear just below the centre of the lower margin.

Leave wide margins, the left hand margin must be 4.0 cm from the left edge of the paper, the right hand margin 2.5 cm from the right edge, the top margin 4.0 cm from the top of the page, and the bottom margin 2.5cm from the bottom of the paper.

The title page of the dissertation must be arranged as follows: Title of the dissertation in capital letters (well centred); indicate your full name (starting with first name, then second name and last name) and the following statement under your name well centred, symmetrically arranged:

The abstract should follow the title page and begin on new page. It should be concise but comprehensive (not more than 300 words).

Table of contents should be sufficiently informative with specific page numbers of all chapters and sections indicated. List of tables should be on a page by itself and arranged in the general format as the Table of contents. List of illustrations (Figures and plates) should also be placed on separate page by

itself and arranged in the same general format as the Table of contents.

Ensure that typescripts are legible, and that the fonts as well as the format are consistent throughout.

To itemize within a paragraph, use the forms (a), (b), (c). Consecutive short sentences can also be itemized by starting them with a bullet point aligned with the left hand column margin and ending them with a semi-colon.

Spelling should follow that of the U. K. English Dictionary. Use "Spell checker" facility in word processing software to assist in checking spellings.

l) Make sure that heading are properly written for each level.

Level 1 e.g. 1.0 USE CAPITAL CASE

Level 2 e.g. 1.1 USE Capitalize Each Word

Level 3 e.g. USE Sentence case

2. FOOTNOTES

(a) Include footnotes in the text only if their use is unavoidable.

(b) Number them consecutively with a superscript number at the relevant author's name or point in the text.

(c) Separate them from the text by a line across half the page.

3. TABLES

a) Type each Table on a separate sheet in case it covers half a page or more. Use upper case "T" for the word "Table" when citing tables in text.

b) Number them consecutively using Arabic numbers (e.g. 1, 2, 3, etc) in the same order they are referred to in the text.

c) Type adequate and self-explanatory captions above the tables. For tables that are presented in a landscape format (horizontal), the caption should be typed at the left hand margin in length-wise.

d) Capitalize only the first letter of the first word of captions

and of column headings in table except where otherwise necessary.

- e) Use the fewest possible lines and avoid use of vertical lines to separate columns. Leave some extra space between the columns instead.
- f) Place acknowledgements of source below Tables cited from other sources, using the format; Source: Mzirai (2008). Zilihona and Mnguu (2008), Ayo *et al.* (2008). Dodoma Regional Commissioner's Office (2008), etc.
- g) Give references for Tables in full only in the references list at the end of the dissertation and not as footnotes to the text.
- h) The words Table, Figure, Appendix or Map which refers a specific table, figures, and maps in the text should start with an upper case letter.
- i) Authors should take notice of limitations set by the size and layout of the document. Large tables should be avoided in the main text and if necessary they should be placed as Appendices at the end of the dissertation. A table in the text should not exceed the printed area of the page. Fold-out is not accepted in the main text. If any data are to be presented, an attempt should be made to divide these over two or more tables or reduce the size using smaller fonts and/or photocopying machine to the extent that is readable.

4. ILLUSTRATIONS/FIGURES

- a) Provide these on separate sheets in case they cover half a page or more.
- b) Number figures sequentially in Arabic numbers (e.g. Figure 1, 2, 3, etc.) and refer to them in the text in order of appearance.

- c) Type adequate and self-explanatory captions below the figure.
- d) Capitalize only the first letter of captions, except where otherwise necessary.
- e) When referring to figures in the text, use the form Fig. 3: (Fig. 8), etc.
- f) As much as possible symbols and lines should be standard, large and thick enough. Free hand drawn lines should be avoided.
- g) Photographs are only acceptable if they have good contrast and intensity. Only sharp and glossy copies should be used.

5. NUMBERS:

- a) For the decimal point, use a stop, not a comma, e.g. write 0.2 not 0,2.
- b) For numbers below unit, precede the decimal point with a zero, e.g. 0.62 not .62.
- c) Spell out numbers from zero to nine, but use figure for higher numbers, e.g. six plots; 10 plots.
- d) In a series of three or more numbers, use figures irrespective of magnitude, e.g. "In trials with 6 cultivars in Zambia, 4 in Malawi and 8 in Mozambique".
- e) Use figures whenever a number is followed by a unit of measure and for days, years, dates, page numbers, classes, etc., e.g. 5 kg, 2 g, 3 days, 1 year, 6 January, page 13, etc.
- f) Spell out numbers that occur at the beginning of sentences.
- g) Express fractions as decimals, though percentages and simple fractions can still be used.
- h) For simple fractions use the form one-quarter, two-thirds, not Yz , $\frac{1}{a}$, $\frac{2}{3}$ etc.
- i) Where possible, avoid large figures ending in several zeros. Either spell them out or use an exponential for part of the number; e.g. for 1600000 write 1.6 million or 1.6×10^6 .

6. PERCENTAGE:

Use the % symbol only with figure, e.g. 62%, but spell out the words percent or percentage when they occur without figures.

9. DATE:

Use the form 22 January, not 22nd

January, January 22 or January 2nd

10. YEAR

- (a) Write in the 1990s not in the 1990's
- (b) For two calendar years write 2001-02, not 2001 02, 2001-2 or 2001-2002
- (c) For single non-calendar years, i.e. parts of two years or seasons that extend over two years, write 2001/02 not 2001 2, 2001-02 or 2001-2002.
- (d) For two non-calendar years, write 2000/01 - 2001/02.

11. LOCAL TERMS:

If local or unfamiliar terms are used, e.g. for plant or animal species, food products, etc. give the scientific names in italics or underlined.

12. ABBREVIATIONS:

- a) Where it is wished to use abbreviations of organizations, technical terms etc., spell them out in full the first time they occur, followed by the abbreviation in brackets, e.g. Institute of Rural development Planning (IRDP), UDOM (The University of Dodoma), etc. Thereafter use the abbreviation only.
- b) In acronyms, degree designations, etc. it is usual to omit full stops, e.g. USA, not U.S.A., CRP not C.R.P.

13. REFERENCES OR LITERATURE CITED:

- (a) List all references cited in full at the end of the text, and not as footnotes to the text pages, tables or figures,
- (b) The references should be arranged alphabetically by authors. All authors, surnames and initials should be included (i.e. never use *et al.*), followed by the year of publication in parentheses; a full stop, the title of the paper or report or book; etc. (as used in the original document and should not be abbreviated), the journal volume number; the issue number (only if the pagination starts afresh in each issue concerned). If the reference is to a book, the publisher, the town of publication, , the edition number (if not the first) should be added. Journal and book titles should be underlined or italicised.

14. CITATIONS IN THE TEXT:

- a) Cite references by author followed by year of publication with separating comma, e.g. (Lifuliro, 2007).
- b) For multiple authorship references cite up to two. For more than two cite the first mentioned, followed by *et al.*, (meaning "and others"), but cite them in full in lists of references.
- c) Citations in the text should take the following forms:
 - i. More than two authors e.g.have been reported by Sebyiga *et al.* (2001), Kinyashi *et al.* (2007) revealed that Girls create fewer problems than boys.
 - ii. For two authors e.g. Njau and Zilihona (2006) found that ..., Girls are considered to create fewer problems than boys (Msuya and Mndendemi, 2005).; other results (Mdendemi and Kinyashi, 2004; Hauli and Mnguu, 2005) have indicated that.....
 - iii. Same authors, two different years e.g. Hawasi and Ndile (2000, 2001) found that
 - iv. Two papers published by the same author in the same year e.g. According to Zilihona (2001a, b)....

- v. Many authors referring to the same issue e.g.
 BNF from free-living rice-associated
 bacteria (Ando *et al.* 1992; Cassman, 1998; Roger
 and Ladha, 1992).; Other reports by Yang *et al.*
 (2003), Pandey and Velasco (2002), Mpeta, 2007) ,
 Kinyashi and Njau (2007) indicated that
- d) To refer to personal communications relating to
 unpublished material, personal communication etc, use
 the form ... (Robinson, J.A. personal communication,
 2001). Do not place such citations in lists of references).
- e) Secondary citations can take the form.... Jones (1922),
 cited by Katega *et al.* (2005).
- f) In order for a dissertation to be recommended for
 examination at least 40% of all reference cited must be
 Journal articles and published not older than 5 years.
 Journal articles may include ones accessed through
 electronic data bases.
- g) For citation drawn from the internet, treat the source in the
 typical citation form in the body of the text i.e. name of the
 web sources/organization, publication date. The URL is to
 be provided in the reference listing. If the year is not
 indicated, use the copy right year as the year of publication

*“Note that no initials are recommended when citing references
in the text”*

15. CITATIONS IN LIST OF REFERENCES:

List all references cited in full at the end of the text.

- a) Cite references in alphabetical order of author(s) and in
 order of year of publication.
- b) For references with same author(s) and year of
 publication, start with papers by the same author being
 arranged in the order of (1) single author, (2) two
 authors alphabetically according to the name of the
 second author, and (3) several authors chronologically
 with 1981a, 1981b, etc. for papers published in the same
 year.

- c) References by one author take precedence over references by the same plus additional authors irrespective of the year of publication.
- d) Avoid using Anon or Anonymous where possible. Where no name of an author is given, use the name of the sponsoring or issuing organization, ministry, department etc. if it can be identified.
- e) Separate authors by semi-colons.
- f) All authors, surnames and initials should be included (i.e. never use *et al.*), followed by the year of publication in parentheses

15. ORDER OF CITATION DETAILS:

The following guidelines and examples are designed to show the main elements that should be cited and the order in which they should appear in references for the three main classes of publication most likely to need inclusion in list of references.

(a) Journals

- Author's name(s) and initials for forenames;
- Year of publication in brackets; followed by a period/full stop
- Title of published paper;
- Name of journal or publication; spelt in full and underlined; or in italics throughout.
- Volume and/or issue number;
- First and last page numbers (in full) for journal papers; total number of pages for publications referred to as a whole.

(b) Books

- Author's or editor's name(s) and initials, name of sponsoring or issuing organization or corporate body in the absence of a named individual author or editor;
- Year of publication in brackets, followed by a period /full stop;

- Title of book to be underlined or in italics;
- Name of publisher and town, in that order;
- Total number of pages in the form: 250pp.

(c) Individual chapters in multi-authored books

- Author's name(s) and initials;
- Year of publication in brackets; followed by a period/ full stop;
- Title of chapter or article, followed by the word In;
- Title of book underlined or in italics;
- The words "Edited by", followed by the name(s) and initials of the editor(s) of the publication, underlined and enclosed in brackets;
- Name of publisher and town, in that order;
 - First and last page numbers of chapter, article, part, or section: pp. 18 - 24.

(d) Proceedings of conferences/workshop/monographs

- Author(s) name(s) and initials;
- Year in bracket; followed by a period or full stop;
- Title of article; followed by: In:
- Title of proceeding or workshop underlined/italics;
- Name of Editor(s) in brackets;
- Date of the conference; town; country; Vol. (if any) page numbers;
- First and last pages of the article: pp. 180 - 194.

(f) Dissertation and Theses

- Author's name and initials,
- Year in bracket; followed by a full stop,
- Title of the dissertation/thesis,
- Name of the host institution,
- Total number of pages.

16. EXAMPLES OF CITATION LAYOUTS

The following examples show how to set out the details needed for the main types of literature listed above. Note the punctuation; words to be printed in italic script or to be underlined.

(a) Journal paper

Nhembo, N.J. (2006). Determinants of Rain Water Harvesting Technology Adoption by Small Scale Farmers in Dodoma Region. *Rural Planning Journal* 8(1): 30-46.

Zilihona, I.J.E. and Fungameza, D. (2006). Perspectives on Rural Development Planning Research in Tanzania: An Overview. *Rural Planning Journal* 8(1): 14-20.

(b) Journal paper accepted for publication but still in press

Malila, M.N. (In press). Energy Utilization Status in Dodoma Region. *Rural Planning Journal*

(c) Books

Mzirai, O. B. (2012). *Modelling of Macro-catchments Rainwater Harvesting in Semi-Arid Areas, Simulation on Maize Production*, Lambert Academic Publishing, GmbH&Co.KG, Saarbrücken, Germany, 128pp.

(d) Edited Books

Gowing, J. and Young, D. (Eds.) (2001). *African Wildlife and livelihoods: The promise and performance of Community Conservation*. James Currey Ltd, Oxford. 336pp.

(e) Individual chapters in multi-authored books

Barrow, E., Gichohi, H. and Infield, M. (2001). The

evolution of community conservation policy and Practice in East Africa. In: *African Wildlife and Livelihoods: The Promise and Performance of Community Conservation*. (Edited by Hulme, D. and Murphree, M.), James Currey Ltd, Oxford. Pp. 59 – 73.

(f) Conference or Workshop proceedings referred to as a whole: Boyle. P.J. (Ed.)(1987). *Appropriate Manpower for Agricultural Research*. Proceedings of SADCC Workshop, Gaborone, Botswana, 25 November, 1985. 120pp.

(g) Individual papers in a conference or workshop
Ishengoma, R. C. and Mugasha, A.G. (2000). Trends and accomplishments of research in forestry and nature conservation at SUA 1996 - 2000. In: *Proceedings of The First University-wide Scientific Conference*. (Edited by Matovelo, J. A. et al.), 5 - 7 April 2000, Morogoro, Tanzania. 28 - 59pp.

(h) Monographs

United States Agency for International Development (2000). *Rice Production in Africa*. Agriserve Ltd., New York, 150pp.

(i) Annual Report

Botswana Ministry of Agriculture (1999). *Livestock Research in Botswana Annual Report*. Government Printer, Gaborone, Botswana. 10pp.

(j) Dissertations

Komba, A.M. (2000). *AIDS Knowledge and Sexual Behaviour in Tanzania: A Demographic and Socio-Economic Analysis*. Dissertation for Award of Post Graduate Diploma in Regional Planning of The Institute of Rural Development Planning, Dodoma, Tanzania, 73pp.

(k) Listing references from electronic sources e.g. internet

For references drawn from the internet, provide the complete URL for the actual web page to which you are referring. Provide

a retrieval data for the citation and paragraph number for direct quote. Regarding a web page and publication date, use either the copyright date or the last update date. If neither of these exist, provide the notation “n.d. (no date) as the publication year. e.g. Kimbrell, A., (2002). Fatal Harvest: The tragedy of industrial agriculture. [<http://www.fatalharvest.org/press.htm>] site visited on 9/8/2002.

(m) Listing references from newspaper articles and other reports

Mwakalebela, L. (2008). Tarmac for all major roads. Daily news, date, Issue No. 9584. p.1.

17. BINDING AND SUBMISSION

- i. It is advisable to have the Secretariat of the Student Research Committee check the unbound dissertation before sending it for hard-binding.
- ii. After certification by the supervisor and Student Research Committee that the candidate has satisfactorily incorporated all the recommended corrections, the candidate shall submit **three** hard bound dissertations and the soft copy of the dissertation.
- iii. Candidates for Post Graduate Diploma Programmes will also be required to submit in a separate cover, one hard copy and one electronic copy of an extract giving a short account of the dissertation made ready for mass production into outreach material in form of leaflets and/or for production prototypes. The extract shall include a title, an introduction, a summary of innovative findings, their perceived usefulness in outreach/industrial/commercial applications and an indication of areas where the results may find immediate application opportunities. The extract shall not exceed 1,000 words. Any submission without the extract shall be deemed to be incomplete and therefore not ready for error free certificate.